



Retarded Golf Association

Official 2026 Tournament Bylaws

Established 2026 | 12 Players | 45 Holes | 2 Days

June 27–28, 2026

Article I — Tournament Overview

The RGA Tournament is a two-day, 45-hole competition played in a team format inspired by the spirit of match play. Twelve players compete as members of one of two captained teams across three rounds of varying formats, accumulating RGA Points to determine the champion.

- 12 players total: 2 Captains + 10 drafted players
- Team names and colors to be determined by Captains prior to the draft
- All 12 players compete in every round
- No handicap strokes applied in any round — all competition is gross score

Article II — Teams & The Draft

Section 2.1 — Captains

The two (2) Captains are designated each year through methods chosen by the Rules Council

- Inaugural 2026 Captains: Jack Foster, Patrick Sullivan

Captains are set prior to the tournament and are non-negotiable. Captains hold authority over their team's strategic decisions throughout the weekend, subject to the rules set forth in these bylaws.

Section 2.2 — The Snake Draft

The ten (10) remaining players shall be distributed between the two teams via a snake draft held on Draft Day, following the buy-in vote. Draft order is determined as follows:



- A coin flip or random draw determines which Captain holds the 1st overall pick
- The snake order proceeds: 1-2 | 2-1 | 1-2 | 2-1 | 1-2 (5 rounds, 2 picks per round)
- Draft picks are binding — no trades or substitutions after the draft concludes

Draft Pool (alphabetical):

- Nathan Cohen, Mitchell Gordon, Samuel Hegarty, Henry Landay, Sean Martin, Charlie Morris, Joseph Santucci, Daniel Schwartzman, Zachary Wagner, Michael Whitney

Article III — Tournament Schedule & Formats

The tournament is held June 27–28, 2026 and spans three rounds totaling 45 holes. All rounds are played gross with no handicap adjustments.

Round	Holes	Format	RGA Points Available	Handicap
Saturday AM	18	2v2 Scramble	3 pts (1 per pair)	None
Saturday PM	9	Shamble	3 pts (1 per pair)	None
Sunday	18	1v1 Singles	6 pts (1 per match)	None

Section 3.1 — Saturday Morning: 2v2 Scramble (18 Holes)

Format: Both players on a pair hit from the tee; the team selects the preferred shot, and both players play from that spot. This continues for every subsequent shot until the ball is holed. The pair with the lower score wins the hole; most holes won after 18 determines the match.

- 3 total matches; Each match is worth 1 RGA Point
- Pairings are set using the alternating-declaration process outlined in Section 3.4

Section 3.2 — Saturday Evening: Shamble (9 Holes)

Format: All players in a pair hit a tee shot. The best tee shot is selected and all players play from that position for the remainder of the hole, each playing their own ball. The lower individual score within the pair counts as the pair's score for that hole.

- 3 total matches; Each match is worth 1 RGA Point
- Pairings are reset for the Shamble and proceed using the same alternating-declaration process (Section 3.4) from that point forward
- The team currently leading in RGA Points after the Scramble declares the first pair for the Shamble; if teams are level, the Captain who declared second in the morning round declares first in the evening



Section 3.3 — Sunday: 1v1 Singles (18 Holes)

Format: Each player competes head-to-head against one member of the opposing team, playing their own ball throughout. The player with the lower gross score on each hole wins that hole. The player who wins more holes after 18 wins the match.

- 6 total matches (one per player pair)
- Each match is worth 1 RGA Point

Section 3.4 — Saturday Pairing Declaration Process

Pairings are set through an alternating declaration system designed to reward strategic sequencing. The process is as follows:

- Step 1: The Captain who held the 1st overall draft pick must declare their first pair
- Step 2: The opposing Captain may then match that pair with any two players from their own roster
- Step 3: The opposing Captain then declares their second pair
- Step 4: The first Captain matches that pair with any two remaining players from their roster
- Step 5: The final four players (two from each team) are automatically paired against each other

Section 3.5 — Sunday Pairing Declaration Process

Sunday 1v1 pairings will follow the same process as the Saturday rounds.

- The Captain whose team leads in RGA Points following the conclusion of Saturday's Scramble and Shamble rounds shall declare their first singles player
 - The opposing Captain then names their counter for that matchup
 - This alternates until five matches are set
 - Captains will play each other as the sixth and final pairing
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Article IV — Scoring & RGA Points

Section 4.1 — RGA Points System

RGA Points are awarded on a per-match basis across all three rounds. A total of 12 RGA Points are available over the course of the tournament.

Result	RGA Points Awarded	Round	Notes
Win	1 point	All Rounds	—
Tie / Halved	0.5 points each	All Rounds	Split evenly
Loss	0 points	All Rounds	—

- Saturday AM Scramble: 3 RGA Points available (3 matches x 1 pt each)
- Saturday PM Shamble: 3 RGA Points available (3 matches x 1 pt each)
- Sunday Singles: 6 RGA Points available (6 matches x 1 pt each)
- Total RGA Points Available: 12
- A team must accumulate 6.5 or more RGA Points to claim outright victory

Section 4.2 — Match Play Scoring

Each individual match is scored hole-by-hole in match play fashion. Conceding holes or putts is permitted by mutual agreement between the two competitors in a given match. A match concluded before 18 holes (or 9 holes in the Shamble) is recorded as a win for the leading player or pair.

Section 4.3 — Tournament Winner & Tiebreaker

The team with the most RGA Points at the conclusion of Sunday Singles is declared the RGA Tournament Champion. In the event of a 6-6 tie, no draw shall be declared. Instead, the two Captains — Jack and Pat — shall compete in a sudden-death playoff hole, to be played immediately following the conclusion of Sunday Singles. The Captain who wins the playoff hole claims the championship for their team. If the playoff hole is halved, play continues hole-by-hole until one Captain posts a lower gross score.

Article V — Buy-In & Prize Structure

The buy-in amount shall be determined by a group vote held on Draft Day. All 12 players are eligible to vote; a simple majority determines the buy-in figure. Buy-ins must be submitted before the draft begins — no exceptions.

- No buy-in, no participation in the draft or the tournament



- The winning team splits the total prize pool evenly among all six (6) members, Captains included
 - In the event the Captain playoff hole determines the winner, the prize pool is still distributed equally across the winning team's full roster
 - Side bets (skins, closest to pin, longest drive, etc.) are entirely separate from the main buy-in and governed independently between the parties involved
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Article VI — Rules of Play

- All play is governed by the current USGA Rules of Golf unless otherwise specified in these bylaws
 - Gimme putts are permitted by mutual agreement within one putter-length of the hole in all formats
 - Lost ball: stroke and distance apply unless a local ground rule is agreed upon by both Captains before the round
 - No handicap strokes are applied in any round — all competition is gross score only
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Article VII — Score Submission & The Official Scoreboard

All match results shall be recorded on the official RGA Tournament scoreboard at rga-tournament.vercel.app. The scoreboard serves as the authoritative record of all RGA Points, match outcomes, and standings throughout the weekend. It is each group's responsibility to ensure scores are submitted accurately and promptly after every round.

Section 7.1 — Designated Scorekeeper

Each group shall designate one (1) scorekeeper before the round begins. The scorekeeper is responsible for:

- Tracking all hole-by-hole scores for their group during the round
- Inputting the final match results into the RGA scoreboard at rga-tournament.vercel.app immediately upon completion of the round
- Ensuring both competing players or pairs have agreed on the final score before submission

The scorekeeper role may be filled by any player in the group and should be agreed upon before the first tee shot. Captains are encouraged to designate scorekeepers for each group as part of pre-round logistics.



Section 7.2 — Score Verification

Before any score is submitted to the official scoreboard, both sides of the match must verbally confirm the result. Submission of a score to the website constitutes official agreement from the submitting group that the result is accurate and final.

- Disputed scores must be raised before submission — not after
- If a scorekeeper fails to submit results within 30 minutes of round completion, the opposing Captain may submit the result on behalf of the group

Section 7.3 — Scoreboard Authority

The RGA scoreboard at rga-tournament.vercel.app is the sole official record of the tournament. Standings, points totals, and match outcomes displayed on the site supersede any verbal or informal claims. All players are encouraged to check the scoreboard during each round to verify their results are correctly recorded.

Article VIII — Disputes

In the event of a rules dispute that cannot be resolved on the course between the competing players, the matter shall be escalated to the RGA RULES Council for adjudication.

- Both Captains shall present their respective positions on the disputed ruling
- Any players directly involved in or witness to the dispute may provide testimony
- The dispute shall be decided by a majority vote of the RULES Council members who are not directly involved in or implicated by the infraction
- If a Captain (or Council member) is a party to the dispute, they are excused from the vote
- Where possible, the deciding vote shall be cast by one eligible Council member from each team, ensuring balanced representation from both sides

All players are expected to cooperate fully and conduct themselves with dignity throughout the process.

Article IX — Conduct & Sportsmanship

- The RGA is a competition built on friendly rivalry — trash talk is not only permitted, it is encouraged
- Personal attacks of any kind will not be tolerated — with the universally acknowledged exception of remarks directed at Mitch's vertical stature, which the league has unanimously deemed fair game
- All players are expected to conduct themselves with the spirit of good-natured competition



- The Spirit of the RGA: Beers are not merely permitted — they are expected and considered a fundamental pillar of fair play. Degeneracy on and off the course is celebrated. Bad shots are to be met with cold beverages, not excuses. Side games, prop bets, and general tomfoolery between rounds are a core part of the RGA experience. We are here to compete, but more importantly, we are here to have an absolute rip of a weekend. Conduct yourself accordingly.
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Article X — Amendments

These bylaws may be amended solely by the RGA Rules Council, which is composed of the following five (5) voting members:

- Zachary Wagner
- Samuel Hegarty
- Nathan Cohen
- Daniel Schwartzman
- Jack Foster

Amendments require a majority vote of the full Council (3 of 5 votes). Any ratified amendment must be communicated to all players no later than 24 hours before the start of the tournament. No amendments may be proposed, debated, or enacted once competition has begun. Captains have no vote in the amendment process.

All amendments must bear the signatures of all five Council members to take effect.



— Signatures & Ratification —

RGA Rules Council

Zachary Wagner _____

Samuel Hegarty _____

Nathan Cohen _____

Daniel Schwartzman _____

Capt. Jack Foster _____

Player Acknowledgements

Capt. Patrick Sullivan _____

Mitchell Gordon _____

Henry Landay _____

Sean Martin _____

Charlie Morris _____

Joseph Santucci _____

Michael Whitney _____